

FROM INDIA TO THE WORLD: BGMI PAVES THE WAY

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Battlegrounds Mobile India (BGMI) might have gained popularity in this country as a favourite pastime, but it has now turned its attention to making major advances in competitive esports.

Krafton's primary tournament in India, the Battlegrounds Mobile Pro India Series (BMPS), started in 2022, and the South Korean company has announced a roadmap for the year in India, which also involves the BGMI International Cup qualifiers, scheduled in late October.

Verstaline Esports won the 2025 edition of Battlegrounds Mobile India Series (BGIS), which ended in April, while Aryan x TMG Gaming was crowned the Battlegrounds Mobile India Pro Series (BMPS) three months later, securing a spot at the Esports World Cup.

BGMI, an Indian version of PlayerUnknown's Battlegrounds (PUBG), has had an interesting last five years in the Indian market. The game – originally known as PUBG – was banned twice due to national security concerns, but has since returned to the Indian market under a different name.

That made BMPS a crucial competition, as its winner then competed in a conventional PUBG pool outside India, at the World Cup, the first such occasion. And in accordance with Krafton's 2025 roadmap, there's more international exposure awaiting Indian esports athletes in their pioneer product. The game's latest competition, called BGMI Showdown (BMSD) 2025, will take place in Hyderabad from late September to mid-October.

Forty-eight teams will compete for a share of the ₹1 crore prize pool, while the top eight teams will qualify for the BGMI International Cup — a tournament featuring 16 teams, comprising four teams each from South Korea and Japan, along with the eight entries from India.

The International Cup is scheduled to be played

between October 31 and November 2.

Japan's entries will be determined through PUBG Mobile Japan League, while South Korea will have PUBG Mobile Pro Series 2025 to confirm its teams for the International Cup.

A THOUGHT FOR THE FUTURE

While Krafton's agenda for 2025 remains clear, it is interesting to also note its plans for the longer term.

Under the Rising Stars program, the company plans to create more esports athletes in the future — a move that could lead to India having a larger presence in global esports contests, given that the Union government has officially acknowledged the need to encourage esports



after banning real-money gaming.

"BGMI Rising Stars 2025 is a celebration of passion, potential, and the future of Indian esports. It's not just about identifying talent—it's about supporting it with intent, helping them grow into the next big names in the industry," Karan Pathak, Associate Director- Esports, KRAFTON India, said.

MEMBERS OF FIRST COHORT OF BGMI RISING STARS 2025:

Shiraj Thapa, Kunal Bhaskar, Thongzalaikam Haokip, Paridhi Gupta, Oleed F, Samihan Kulkarni, Saumya Raj, Anand Aman.

Answer to previous issue's quiz:
Debanjan 'DEATHMAKER' Das